

Canada	4.0%	1937	4.6%	29	1%	19	40%
United States	3.9%	1937	4.4%	28	2%	18	39%
New Zealand	3.8%	1935	4.1%	27	8%	18	40%
Denmark	3.7%	1937	4.2%	25	7%	19	59%
World Portfolio	3.5%	1937	3.9%	22	15%	16	56%
Australia	3.4%	1937	3.7%	21	16%	15	38%
United Kingdom	3.4%	1937	3.8%	22	23%	16	46%
Switzerland	3.1%	1915	3.4%	19	32%	13	59%
Sweden	3.1%	1914	3.8%	19	14%	13	47%
South Africa	3.0%	1937	3.8%	21	15%	17	29%
Norway	3.0%	1939	3.1%	17	45%	12	66%
World Ex-US	3.0%	1937	3.5%	19	25%	15	48%
Netherlands	2.8%	1941	3.8%	17	21%	13	62%
Ireland	2.8%	1937	3.2%	19	36%	14	62%
Spain	2.2%	1936	2.6%	12	51%	10	83%
Belgium	1.5%	1914	1.9%	9	48%	7	64%
Finland	1.3%	1917	1.8%	6	40%	5	52%
Germany	1.0%	1914	1.3%	3	53%	3	68%
France	0.8%	1943	1.3%	7	71%	6	82%
Italy	0.8%	1940	1.1%	5	76%	4	83%
Japan	0.3%	1937	0.3%	3	36%	3	44%
Austria	0.1%	1914	0.1%	5	62%	4	75%

Note: Assumptions include a thirty-year retirement duration, no investment fees, constant inflation-adjusted withdrawal amounts, and annual rebalancing.

With a 50/50 asset allocation in this data set, the 4 percent rule survived in Canada (4.0 percent) and came very close in the United States (3.9 percent). Even allowing for a 10 percent failure rate, 4 percent made the cut only in Canada, the United States, New Zealand, and Denmark. In half of the countries, the SAFEMAX fell below 3 percent. World War II–era Japan, in particular, faced the sort of crisis suggested by William Bernstein, as the SAFEMAX was only 0.3 percent for 1937 retirees. The 4 percent rule would have supported expenditures for only three years. Meanwhile, hyperinflation in Austria led hypothetical retirees at the start of World War I to only sustain a 0.1 percent withdrawal rate from their portfolio. Shockingly, the 4 percent rule would have failed more than